

Fabloid COUPLES

Romance is commerce as Bollywood turns its dazzling duos into prime time property, as they move seamlessly from brand endorsements to big screen extravaganzas

| By Kaveree Bamzai |

Kaminey has an operatic director in Vishal Bhardwaj, a powerful cast of minor characters and a psychedelic style of editing, but guess what its marketers would like to highlight? A steamy kiss between the are-they-aren't-they couple Priyanka Chopra and Shahid Kapur. The two, who recently exited high-profile relationships, have only added to the rumours by being seen at popular Mumbai hangouts like Aarus and swish restaurants like Spices at JW Marriott. Ever since the

MMS clip of Kareena Kapoor and Shahid Kapur broke the barrier on unmarried couples indulging in a little PDA in 2005, the glamour industry has discovered that star couples sell. They sell shampoo and DTH like Saif Ali Khan and Kareena, movies like Abhishek Bachchan and Aishwarya Rai Bachchan, and in some cases, they even act as a launchpad, as happened with Adhyayan Suman who was happy to hype his relationship with Kangna Ranaut for his second film, *Raaz: The Mystery Continues*.

In a world of multiple choice pop culture, being a celebrity doesn't have much staying power. Being part of a celebrity couple makes you more durable. Five years of Brad Pitt and Angelina Jolie's very public romance, with the ghost of wife past Jennifer Aniston perpetually between them, testifies to it. Brangelina may have used their

THE PRINCE AND THE DIVA

ABHISHEK BACHCHAN
& AISHWARYA RAI BACHCHAN

They hate the name Abhiash but know their media equity. She vets his female co-stars and his new diet. He sings her praises.

THE NUBILE NEWBIES

RANBIR KAPOOR & DEEPIKA PADUKONE

They have travelled the route taken by all contemporary couples: an endorsement together, parties in tandem, and yes, a movie where they ended up happily ever after.



YOGESH SHAH

AP PHOTO

